II

PART TWO · ✦

The People of the Text

Almost everyone in this book has been flattened into a lesson by somebody who needed them to mean one thing. Go back and find out what they actually did.

i · How to read a person	369
ii · The women of the Hebrew Bible	370
iii · The women of the New Testament	390
iv · The men	397
v · Who echoes whom	404

How to read a person

Every profile in this part runs the same fields, and the order matters. It starts with what the person has been reduced to, because that reduction is what you inherited, and it'll keep steering your instincts until it's written down and looked at. The text comes next, only what's on the page, including the parts that are inconvenient for everyone.

After that, the Empire's use of them, because Dominion has a position on each of these people, and a state that quotes scripture is always curating a gallery of approved and cautionary lives. After that come the echoes in your own cast, and most important, where the parallel breaks, because the break is where your character stops being a reference and starts being a person.

USUALLY REDUCED TO	The received version: the sermon, the flannelgraph, the insult the name has become.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Only what's written, with the silences marked as silences and left unfilled.
WHAT DOMINION DOES	The Empire's official reading, and what it needs that reading to authorize.
TKC ECHOES	Which of your characters this lights up, and in which scene.
WHERE IT BREAKS	The required field. No character is an allegory, and the difference is the character.
QUESTIONS AND NOTES	Yours. Nothing printed here has any claim on it.

A NOTE ON THE UNNAMED

A great many women in this collection have no name: Lot's wife, Jephthah's daughter, the woman of Judges 19, the woman who bled for twelve years, the woman at the well, the woman who anointed him. Who got a name tells you who was doing the recording. The Registry makes the same choices.

PEOPLE ALREADY WORKED

Sarah, Rebekah, Leah, Dinah, Shiphrah and Puah, and Zipporah are worked in the Genesis and Exodus dossiers and cross-referenced here.

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Deep dives I and II · the cast-name table at the end of this part.

OT | ORIGINS

THEMES

Asking · blame · naming · the first speech

MARGINALIA

Eve

Genesis 2–4 · the woman of the garden · the first dialogue in the Bible

USUALLY REDUCED TO	The woman who brought sin into the world.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Called *ishshah*, "woman," by the man, and named Ḥawwah, "mother of all living," only after the judgment (3.20). Her conversation with the serpent is the first dialogue in the Bible. She names her sons, and both times she speaks of God: "I have gotten a man with the LORD" (4.1), "God has appointed for me another offspring" (4.25). Genesis 3 doesn't curse her, and the word "sin" doesn't appear in it.
WHERE THE BLAME CAME FROM	Later, and from outside the chapter. Sirach, about 180 BCE: "from a woman sin had its beginning." 1 Timothy 2.14: "Adam was not deceived, but the woman was." Tertullian, about 200 CE: "you are the devil's gateway." Paul's undisputed letters put it on Adam: "sin came into the world through one man" (Rom 5.12).
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** The Broadcast's Eve problem, the woman "blamed for asking rather than thanked" (**TR**), runs the man's defense from 3.12.
WHERE IT BREAKS	Eve is never asked what she wanted. Eden is asked constantly, on camera, and graded on the answer.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

✣ *See also:* Deep dive I, Genesis, pages 2 and 4.

Hagar

OT | CHARACTER

Genesis 16 · 21 · Egyptian · enslaved · the only person in scripture who names God

USUALLY REDUCED TO	A subplot. The servant who caused trouble, the mistake made while waiting on a promise, the woman whose son wasn't chosen.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	An enslaved foreign woman handed to her mistress's husband with no recorded consent and no line of dialogue until she's pregnant and being mistreated. She runs once. In the desert she's met, addressed by name, given a promise about her own descendants, and told to go back. When the chosen son is born she's expelled with bread and a skin of water, and she sets the boy under a bush because she can't watch him die. She's the one who names God, El-roi, the God who sees. Nobody else in Genesis does that. She later takes a wife for Ishmael from Egypt, head of her own household.
AFTERLIVES	Paul makes her an allegory of slavery (Gal 4). Islamic tradition honors her as Hajar, and pilgrims at Mecca retrace her run between two hills. Delores Williams built womanist theology on her survival in *Sisters in the Wilderness* (1993).
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** Makes her a warning about the servant who forgets her place, and cites the order to return as proof God sends women back to the households they flee. Her naming of God isn't taught.
TKC ECHOES	Any woman whose body is the instrument of someone else's covenant. The candidate who's used and then surplus.
WHERE IT BREAKS	Hagar is met in the wilderness and survives it twice. If your character runs and no one meets her, that's a different theology, and you should know which one you're writing.

THEMES

Surrogacy · exile · being seen · the used body

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Deep dive I, Genesis, page 8.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

Tamar

Genesis 38 · twice widowed · defrauded of her claim · declared righteous by the man who wronged her

USUALLY REDUCED TO	A scandal skipped in public reading. If she's mentioned, she's the woman who pretended to be a prostitute.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Married into a family, widowed, married to the next brother by custom, widowed again, and sent back to her father's house while the family quietly keeps the third son from her. She's left in legal limbo, neither wife nor free, with no court to appeal to. She veils herself, waits on the road her father-in-law will travel, and takes his seal, cord and staff as a pledge. Accused and sentenced to burn, she sends the three items with a message: "Identify whose these are." He says she's more righteous than he is. Her son Perez enters the royal line.
HOW SCRIPTURE REMEMBERS HER	The elders bless Ruth's marriage, "may your house be like the house of Perez, whom Tamar bore to Judah" (Ruth 4.12), and Matthew names her in Jesus' genealogy (1.3).
WHAT DOMINION DOES	POSSIBLE Omits her. There's no usable version of a story in which a woman entraps a patriarch, is vindicated by the record and written into the ancestry of kings.
TKC ECHOES	Any woman with no legal standing who has to create evidence. She doesn't accuse. She collects.
WHERE IT BREAKS	Tamar's society had a law on her side that wasn't being enforced. If Dominion's law is against your character, producing evidence won't be enough. She'll have to change the court.

OT | CHARACTER

THEMES

Legal limbo · evidence · veiling · vindication

MARGINALIA

✤ *See also:* Deep dive I, Genesis, pages 7 and 8.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

Miriam

Exodus 2 · 15 · Numbers 12 · 20 · Micah 6.4 · the first woman the Torah calls a prophet

WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Moses' sister, if the unnamed girl at the river is her. Called "the prophet" at the sea, where she leads the women with a hand drum (Exod 15.20–21). She and Aaron challenge Moses' sole authority, and she alone is struck with a skin disease. The camp doesn't move until she's brought back (Num 12). She dies at Kadesh, and the next verse says there was no water (Num 20.1–2). The rabbis built on that the tradition of Miriam's well, which traveled with Israel for her sake. Micah names her with Moses and Aaron as the three God sent.
HER NAME	Miriam in Greek is Mariam, which is where every Mary in the New Testament gets hers.
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** Teaches Numbers 12 as the lesson on women who speak against ordained authority, and leaves out the song and the well.
TKC ECHOES	Eden's mother carries her name (**TL**). Miriam was reassigned to another man's household after Thomas left (**FR 0**), and Celeste has no proof she's alive (**FR 16**).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The biblical camp waits for Miriam. Whether anyone in the Empire waits for this one is the question.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

EXOD 2

EXOD 15.20–21

NUM 12

NUM 20.1–2

MIC 6.4

B. TA'ANIT 9A

TKC: MIRIAM · TL

JUDG 4–5

JUDG 5.1

JUDG 5.7

JUDG 5.28–30

TKC: DOM

Deborah

Judges 4–5 · prophet · judge · the problem no empire has solved

USUALLY REDUCED TO	An exception. The woman God used because no man was available, a reading the text doesn't support anywhere.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Already a prophet and the judge of Israel when we meet her, hearing cases under a palm tree. No emergency is offered to excuse it, and no apology. **CONTESTED** *'eshet lappidot* can mean "wife of Lappidoth" or "a woman of torches." She summons the commander Barak, who won't go unless she goes with him. She goes, and tells him the glory will go to a woman. It goes to Jael, a civilian who kills the enemy general with a tent peg. The victory song, among the oldest poetry in the Bible, calls her "a mother in Israel" and ends with Sisera's mother at her window imagining her son dividing the spoil, "a womb or two for every man."
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** Emergency doctrine. She's taught as a temporary provision for a lawless age, proof that when men fail God shames them by using a woman. Her authority becomes an insult aimed at men, and stops being a precedent for women.
TKC ECHOES	The woman with real authority who's constantly called an exception so the rule survives. And the general who'll only act if a woman stands beside him.
WHERE IT BREAKS	Deborah is never punished, never diminished and never justifies herself. If your character's authority costs her something, the cost is your invention, and worth being honest about.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said Deborah composed the song. The heading credits "Deborah and Barak" (5.1). The song speaks of her in the first person in places, and who composed it isn't stated.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

JOSH 2

JOSH 6.22–25

JOSEPHUS, ANT. 5.1.2

MATT 1.5

HEB 11.31

JAS 2.25

RUTH 1–4

RUTH 3.9

LEV 19.9–10

DEUT 23.3

Rahab · Ruth

Two foreign women who talk their way into the royal genealogy.

RAHAB · JOSHUA 2, 6	**Reduced to:** her profession, permanently. A *zonah*, usually "prostitute" (Josephus calls her an innkeeper). **The text:** her house is built into the city wall. She hides two spies, lies to the king's men, and gives an assessment of the war more accurate than anything her own city has produced: "I know that the LORD has given you the land." She bargains for her whole household, and the spies swear an oath and tell her to tie a scarlet cord in her window. When the city falls they bring her family out, "and she has lived in Israel to this day." The New Testament remembers her three times. **Dominion:** POSSIBLE: a conversion story, the fallen woman who chose correctly, never a woman who conducted foreign policy from the wall. **Breaks:** Rahab's intelligence is believed. Ask whether yours would be.
RUTH · THE BOOK OF RUTH	**Reduced to:** a wedding reading. **The text:** a Moabite widow with no obligation to anyone, who binds herself to her mother-in-law in the most famous vow of devotion in scripture, spoken by a woman to a woman. She gleans as a foreign laborer under the harvest-edge law. Naomi sends her to the threshing floor to uncover Boaz's feet and wait, "and he will tell you what to do." Ruth doesn't wait. She tells him to spread his cloak over her, the same word he'd used for the wings of the God she'd sheltered under. When the son is born, the women say "a son has been born to Naomi," and that Ruth is better to her than seven sons. Deuteronomy 23.3 bars Moabites from the assembly, and the book writes one into the royal line. **Dominion:** POSSIBLE: the model immigrant who assimilates completely, the threshing floor retold as modesty and the vow given to a husband. **Breaks:** Ruth's gamble works because one man chose to honor a law he could have ignored.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said Rahab's deal was "in writing." It's an oath and a scarlet cord, and the text doesn't say her house was left standing. It also said Ruth proposed on Naomi's coaching. Naomi told her Boaz would tell her what to do, and Ruth spoke first.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

1 SAM 1–2

1 SAM 25

1 SAM 18–19

2 SAM 3.13–16

2 SAM 6.16–23

B. MEGILLAH 14A

LUKE 1.46–55

TKC: TL · WR

Hannah · Abigail · Michal

Three women of the early monarchy, and the three ways the record lets a woman speak to power.

HANNAH · 1 SAMUEL 1–2	One of two wives, provoked for years by the one with children. Her husband asks, "Am I not more to you than ten sons?" She prays at the sanctuary with her lips moving and no sound, and the priest thinks she's drunk. She corrects him. She vows her son to God's service, leaves him at Shiloh after weaning, and brings him a little robe every year. Her song says the LORD raises the poor from the dust and brings down the mighty, and it's the model for Mary's song. It ends with the first mention in the Bible's order of a king as God's "anointed," from a woman praying before Israel has a king.
ABIGAIL · 1 SAMUEL 25	Married to Nabal, a rich man called harsh. David, an outlaw with six hundred men, asks for provisions in return for having left Nabal's shepherds unharmed. **INTERPRETATION** Many readers hear a protection payment. Nabal refuses, and David arms four hundred men to kill every male in the house. Abigail loads donkeys with food and rides out without telling her husband. She kneels, takes the blame on herself, and talks David out of blood guilt he'd regret as king. Nabal dies ten days later, and David marries her. The Talmud counts her among seven women prophets.
MICHAL · 1 SAMUEL 18–19, 2 SAMUEL 3, 6	Saul's daughter. The narrator says she loved David, a thing the Hebrew Bible rarely says of a woman. She saves his life by letting him down through a window and putting an idol in his bed. Saul gives her to another man, Palti. David later demands her back as a political condition, and Palti follows her weeping until he's ordered home. When David dances before the ark she despises him, and the chapter ends: "Michal the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death."

FOR TKC

Hannah is House Mother of House Aurem (**TL**). "Six Trials. Twelve girls. None of them hers" (**TL**). Abigail is the House's Debate and Protocol Advisor, "pressure in a pretty dress" (**WR 30**). **POSSIBLE** Hannah's story runs the biblical one in reverse, a woman deciding whether to give her daughter Naomi to the institution she's served (**FR 29**).

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

2 SAM 11–12

2 SAM 13

1 KGS 1–2

MATT 1.6

TRIBLE, TEXTS OF TERROR (1984)

Bathsheba · Tamar of the palace

What the court does to a woman it has already harmed.

CONTENT NOTE Sexual violence and murder.

BATHSHEBA · 2 SAMUEL 11–12, 1 KINGS 1–2	**Reduced to:** a temptress on a roof. **The text:** she's purifying herself after her period, and the text doesn't say where. Every verb in the scene belongs to the king: he saw, he sent, he took. Her only words are "I am pregnant," two words in Hebrew. Her husband is killed on David's written order, carried in his own hand. Nathan's parable makes her the poor man's lamb. Her first child dies. Decades later she works with Nathan to put her son on the throne and sits at his right hand as queen mother. Matthew names her only as "the wife of Uriah." **Dominion:** POSSIBLE: keeps the roof and drops the verbs. A woman's visible body explains a powerful man's decision, the most useful doctrine a court can have. **Breaks:** Bathsheba survives into power. Ask what that costs, and what she becomes.
TAMAR · 2 SAMUEL 13	**Reduced to:** nothing. Most people raised in church have never heard of her. **The text:** a princess sent by her father's own instruction to her half-brother's sickroom, and raped there. Before it she argues, tells him "such a thing is not done in Israel," and offers a lawful alternative. Afterward she tears the robe worn by the king's virgin daughters, puts ashes on her head and goes away crying aloud. Her full brother tells her to be quiet. Her father is very angry and does nothing. She lives "a desolate woman" in her brother's house, and that's the last line she gets. Absalom later names his own daughter Tamar. **Dominion:** POSSIBLE: never read aloud. A king burying his daughter's assault to protect the succession isn't survivable material for a dynasty. **Breaks:** Tamar's outcry changes nothing. If your character's does, you've chosen mercy. Earn it.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion placed Bathsheba bathing "in her own home" and gave her first words as five. The text doesn't give the place, and the words are two in Hebrew.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

1 KGS 16.31

1 KGS 21

2 KGS 9.30–37

2 KGS 11

2 KGS 22.14–20

ESTH 1–2

REV 2.20

WHITE, AR'N'T I A WOMAN? (1985)

TKC: DOM · FR 33

Jezebel · Athaliah · Huldah · Vashti

Four women with public power, and four ways the record handles it.

JEZEBEL · 1 KINGS 16–21, 2 KINGS 9	A Sidonian princess married to Ahab who supports Baal worship and has the LORD's prophets killed. When Naboth won't sell his vineyard, she writes letters in Ahab's name, seals them with his seal and arranges false witnesses so Naboth is executed by correct procedure. The crime is real. Her death comes in 2 Kings 9. She paints her eyes, calls down to the usurper from her window and is thrown out of it. **Afterlife:** the name became an insult for any woman with influence, and under slavery and Jim Crow "Jezebel" named a stereotype of Black women as sexually predatory, used to excuse their abuse. The insult makes power the sin, more than the murder.
ATHALIAH · 2 KINGS 11	The only woman to rule Judah in her own name, for six years. She takes the throne by killing the royal family, as several male kings took theirs. An infant prince survives because his aunt Jehosheba hides him in the temple. In the seventh year a priest crowns the boy, and Athaliah cries "Treason! Treason!" before she's killed. Her reign is recorded as usurpation, and the same conduct in men as accession.
HULDAH · 2 KINGS 22	A prophet in Jerusalem. When the law scroll is found in the temple, King Josiah sends the high priest, the royal secretary and three other officials to inquire of the LORD, and they go to her. Jeremiah and Zephaniah were active, and nobody explains why they chose her or remarks that she's a woman. She authenticates the scroll and gives an oracle, and the greatest reform in the kingdom's history follows. **Dominion:** POSSIBLE: not in the syllabus at any level. The biblical Huldah has no connection to the Prelate, whose working name is Aurelia (POSSIBLE, FR 33).
VASHTI · ESTHER 1	Ordered to appear in her crown before drunk officials, she refuses. The advisers panic about precedent, since every wife will hear of it. She's deposed by decree, and letters go out that every man is to be master in his own house. The plot of the book runs on her empty place.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion cited 1 Kings for Jezebel's death. It's 2 Kings 9. It also said Vashti is "never mentioned again." The king remembers her in 2.1, and Esther is made queen "instead of Vashti."

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THESE FOUR IS IN DOMINION'S SYLLABUS, AND HOW SHE'S TAUGHT

ESTH 2–9

ESTH 4.14–16

ESTH 9.29–32

PROV 31

RUTH 3.11

TKC: DR3 · TR

Esther · the woman of worth

ESTHER · THE BOOK OF ESTHER	Hadassah, an orphan raised by her cousin, is "taken" in a royal search for young virgins. Twelve months of beauty treatment, six with oil of myrrh and six with spices, then one night with the king. She hides her people on her cousin's instruction. When Haman wins a decree to destroy the Jews, Mordecai says "Who knows whether you have not come to the kingdom for such a time as this?" Approaching the king unsummoned is punishable by death, and she goes: "If I perish, I perish." She works through two banquets, exposes Haman and wins a counter-decree. In chapter 9 the Jews kill their attackers, seventy-five thousand in the provinces. She then writes with full authority to fix Purim, so the book ends with her issuing a decree. God isn't named anywhere in the Hebrew. The Assessment in Draft Three uses "Esther's crown" as proof a woman could influence government "so long as she was beautiful, obedient, and prepared to die for the privilege" (**DR3**).
THE WOMAN OF WORTH · PROVERBS 31	An acrostic poem. *ʾEshet ḥayil* is usually "virtuous" or "capable" wife, and *ḥayil* also means an army's strength and wealth. She buys a field and plants a vineyard with her own earnings, makes garments and sells them to merchants, "opens her mouth with wisdom," and her husband is known at the gates because of her. The chapter opens with what King Lemuel's mother taught him: stay off wine when judging, and "open your mouth for the mute… defend the rights of the poor and needy." Boaz uses the same phrase for Ruth. Verse 29 is printed on the Assessment and read before the scores (**DR3**). In Jewish practice it's sung at the Friday evening table.

FOR TKC

The Trials are a state search for young women with a long preparation (**TR**). **POSSIBLE** The Temple teaches Vashti right before Esther as the warning, and never teaches that Esther ends the book issuing a decree in her own name.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

GEN 19.26

JUDG 11.29–40

JUDG 19–21

2 KGS 4.1–37

2 KGS 8.1–6

TRIBLE, TEXTS OF TERROR

The unnamed, and two widows

CONTENT NOTE The woman of Judges 19, sexual violence and dismemberment. Jephthah's daughter, a child sacrifice.

LOT'S WIFE · GENESIS 19	Looks back at Sodom and becomes a pillar of salt. No name.
JEPHTHAH'S DAUGHTER · JUDGES 11	Her father vows to sacrifice whatever comes out of his house first if he wins. She comes out dancing. She asks for two months in the mountains with her companions to mourn, he carries out the vow, and "it became a custom" for the daughters of Israel to lament her four days a year. No name.
THE WOMAN OF JUDGES 19	A Levite's secondary wife. At Gibeah men surround the house demanding the guest, and the Levite pushes her outside. She's raped all night and found at dawn with her hands on the threshold. He cuts her body into twelve pieces and sends them through Israel. The civil war that follows ends with the abduction of the women of Jabesh-gilead and the dancing girls of Shiloh. "Everyone did what was right in his own eyes." No name.
THE PROPHET'S WIDOW · 2 KINGS 4	A creditor is about to take her two children as slaves. Elisha tells her to borrow every empty jar, shut the door and pour her one jar of oil. It runs until the jars do. She pays the debt and lives on the rest. The miracle keeps two children out of debt slavery.
THE SHUNAMMITE · 2 KINGS 4, 8	A wealthy woman who builds Elisha a room. When her son dies she rides to the prophet and won't leave without him. Years later she comes home from a famine to find her land taken, petitions the king herself, and gets it back with the income it earned while she was gone.

WHICH UNNAMED WOMAN IN THE EMPIRE'S RECORDS I'LL GIVE A NAME TO

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH UNNAMED WOMAN IN THE EMPIRE'S RECORDS I'LL GIVE A NAME TO

LUKE 1–2

LUKE 1.34–38

LUKE 1.46–55

JOHN 2.1–5

MARK 3.21, 31–35

JOHN 19.25–27

ACTS 1.14

ISA 7.14

TKC: DOM

Mary of Nazareth

Luke 1–2 · Mark 3 · John 2 · 19 · Acts 1 · a young woman who sings about thrones emptied

USUALLY REDUCED TO	Serenity. A statue in blue, silent and compliant, the whole personality reduced to one word of consent.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	Told she'll bear a son, she asks a practical question, "How will this be?", before she agrees. She goes "with haste" to Elizabeth's house in the hill country and stays three months, and the song she sings there takes Hannah's as its model: God has brought down the mighty from their thrones, filled the hungry and sent the rich away empty, all in the past tense, as though already done. At Cana she tells him there's no wine and tells the servants to do whatever he says. In Mark the family comes to take him home because people say he's out of his mind. She stands at the cross in John and is with the disciples after.
CONTESTED	Matthew quotes Isaiah 7.14 from the Greek, "a virgin shall conceive." The Hebrew *ʿalmah* means a young woman of marriageable age, and the translation is one of the oldest disputes between Jewish and Christian readers. Luke never gives her age. **INFERENCE** The usual "teenager" comes from ancient marriage customs.
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** Builds a doctrine of womanhood on her single yes and sets the song so gently nobody hears the words. The revolution she sings is footnoted as spiritual.
WHERE IT BREAKS	Her consent is asked for. An angel waits for an answer. At an Aurem Binding, "nobody asks if she consents. They ask if she is worthy" (**DOM**). **INTERPRETATION** Every Binding held in a Temple that honors Mary contradicts the story it honors.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said she "travels alone" to Elizabeth's. The text doesn't say whether anyone went with her.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

LUKE 8.1–3

JOHN 20.11–18

LUKE 24.10–11

GREGORY THE GREAT, HOMILY 33 (591)

JOHN 4.1–42

TKC: TR

Mary Magdalene · the woman at the well

Two women sent to speak, and what was said about them afterward.

MARY MAGDALENE · ALL FOUR GOSPELS	**Reduced to:** a prostitute. The text never says so. **The text:** from Magdala. Seven demons had gone out of her, and she and other women supported Jesus and the twelve "out of their own means." She's at the cross and the burial in all four and named first in most lists of the women. In John she's the first to see the risen Jesus and is sent to tell the disciples, "I have seen the Lord." In Luke the apostles think the women's report is nonsense. **Afterlife:** Pope Gregory the Great merged her with the unnamed sinful woman of Luke 7 and with Mary of Bethany in a sermon in 591, and it stuck for fourteen centuries. The Catholic calendar dropped the identification in 1969 and in 2016 raised her memorial to a feast with the old title "apostle to the apostles." **TKC:** POSSIBLE: The Broadcast's Eve narrative "implies and never accuses" (**TR**), and the reputations it assigns outlast the Trial.
THE WOMAN AT THE WELL · JOHN 4	**Reduced to:** her five husbands. **The text:** a Samaritan woman at noon. Jesus asks her for a drink, and she asks why a Jewish man is asking a Samaritan woman. Their conversation is the longest Jesus has with any one person in the gospels. She raises the live dispute between their peoples, Gerizim or Jerusalem, and gets a serious answer. He says she's had five husbands, and the text doesn't explain or condemn it. She's the first person in John to whom he says plainly he's the Messiah. She leaves her water jar, and "many Samaritans believed because of the woman's testimony." She's never given a name. **Breaks:** she gets a real answer. Ask who in Dominion would answer her.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said "women in that world did not divorce men." Under Jewish law only a husband could start a divorce, and Roman law let either spouse. The text doesn't say how her marriages ended.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

MARK 5.25–34

LEV 15.25–30

MARK 14.3–9

LUKE 10.38–42

JOHN 11.27

JOHN 12.1–8

The bleeding woman, the anointer, Martha and Mary

THE WOMAN WHO BLED TWELVE YEARS · MARK 5	She's spent everything on doctors and gotten worse. She comes up behind him in a crowd and touches his cloak. Under Leviticus 15 she'd count as impure. He stops and asks who touched him, and she comes forward trembling and tells "the whole truth." He calls her "Daughter." The story is set inside the raising of a twelve-year-old girl. **INTERPRETATION** She takes what she needs without permission and is commended for it.
THE WOMAN WHO ANOINTED HIM · MARK 14	Two days before his arrest an unnamed woman breaks a jar of costly ointment over his head. The men scold her for the waste, and he says wherever the gospel is preached, what she's done will be told in memory of her. Her name wasn't kept.
MARTHA AND MARY OF BETHANY · LUKE 10, JOHN 11–12	In Luke, Mary sits at his feet, the posture of a disciple, while Martha is "distracted with much serving." He says Mary has chosen the good portion. In John, Martha makes the confession Peter makes in the other gospels: "You are the Christ, the Son of God." Mary anoints his feet and wipes them with her hair.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

The women who ran things

Named, titled and working, in the same letters used to silence women. Any institution has to choose which list is the rule.

PHOEBE · ROMANS 16	A *diakonos* of the church at Cenchreae, the word translated "deacon" for men, and a *prostatis*, a patron, "of many and of myself as well." INFERENCE: She carried the letter to Rome, and couriers often read letters aloud and explained them. The KJV and ESV call her a "servant." The NRSV and NIV (2011) say "deacon."
JUNIA · ROMANS 16	Greeted with Andronicus as "of note among the apostles," and as Paul's fellow prisoners. Early writers including John Chrysostom read her as a woman apostle. From the Middle Ages many editions printed a masculine "Junias," a name with no ancient attestation. Eldon Epp traces the change (2005). CONTESTED "Prominent among the apostles" or "well known to the apostles."
PRISCILLA · ACTS 18, ROMANS 16	A tentmaker with her husband Aquila, with a church in their house. When the gifted preacher Apollos arrives knowing only John's baptism, they take him aside and explain "the way of God more accurately." She's named first in four of six mentions.
LYDIA · ACTS 16	A dealer in purple cloth, a luxury trade, with her own household and no husband mentioned. The first person baptized in Philippi. She insists the missionaries stay with her, and after prison they go back to her house to meet the believers. The patron.

ROM 16.1–7

ACTS 18.24–26

ACTS 16.11–15, 40

ACTS 9.36–43

ACTS 6.1–6

1 TIM 5.3–16

EPP, JUNIA (2005)

TKC: DOM

ROM 16.1–7

ACTS 18.24–26

ACTS 16.11–15, 40

ACTS 9.36–43

ACTS 6.1–6

1 TIM 5.3–16

EPP, JUNIA (2005)

TKC: DOM

The women who ran things, continued

TABITHA · ACTS 9	The only person in the New Testament called *mathētria*, the feminine of "disciple." When she dies, the widows show Peter the garments she'd made. Mutual aid, recorded as ministry.
THE WIDOWS · ACTS 6, 1 TIMOTHY 5	The first recorded dispute in Jerusalem is over Greek-speaking widows neglected in the daily food. 1 Timothy sets up an enrolled order of widows, age sixty and up, with support.

FOR TKC

POSSIBLE Titles like deacon and patron are rendered as domestic words in some translations, and the Empire's designations do the same on purpose. Tabitha's widows look like Irongate's Kitchen and Meridian's Reading Circles (**DOM**).

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said Junia was "imprisoned for it," for being an apostle. The text says only that she'd been in prison with Paul.

WHO IS MY PHOEBE, MY LYDIA, MY JUNIA

The founders

The founders aren't presented as moral exemplars. They're presented, with startling candor, as men whose obedience keeps endangering the people in their care.

ABRAHAM · GENESIS 12–25	Held up as the model of faith. The text records him twice passing his wife off as his sister to protect himself, sending Hagar and Ishmael into the wilderness, and taking his son up a mountain with a knife. It also records him bargaining with God over Sodom, from fifty righteous down to ten: "Shall not the Judge of all the earth do what is just?" Paul reads him as justified by faith, James by works. **POSSIBLE** Dominion preaches the mountain and never the bargaining.
JACOB · GENESIS 25–35	Buys his brother's birthright for stew and takes the blessing by disguise. Deceived in turn on his wedding night, he works twenty years under shifting terms. He wrestles all night, is renamed Israel, "strives with God," and limps afterward. He loves Rachel over Leah and Joseph over his brothers, openly. **For TKC:** the favoritism engine.
JUDAH · GENESIS 37–38, 43–44	Leah's fourth son. He proposes selling Joseph instead of killing him, wrongs Tamar and admits it, and in Egypt offers himself as a slave in Benjamin's place, in the longest speech in Genesis. His name became the tribe's, the kingdom's and finally the word "Jew."
JOSEPH · GENESIS 37–50	Sold, imprisoned on a false accusation, and raised to run Egypt's grain. His famine policy ends with the population selling its land and itself to the crown. "You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good." **For TKC:** the competent administrator whose competence builds the machine.
MOSES · EXODUS–DEUTERONOMY	Raised in the palace of the regime killing his people. He kills an overseer and runs to Midian. He argues with God five times before he goes and later talks God out of destroying the people. He's eighty when he faces Pharaoh. Barred from the land after striking the rock, he dies in sight of it, in a grave no one knows.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said Moses spent "forty years as a shepherd." Exodus doesn't give the length. The forty years come from Stephen's speech (Acts 7) and later tradition.

GEN 12–25

GEN 18.22–33

GEN 25–35

GEN 37–50

GEN 44.18–34

EXOD 2.11–15

EXOD 7.7

ACTS 7.23, 30

KIERKEGAARD, FEAR AND TREMBLING (1843)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

David

1 Samuel 16 – 1 Kings 2 · the man every scriptural monarchy has claimed as precedent

USUALLY REDUCED TO	A boy with a sling, a psalmist with a harp, and "a man after God's own heart." Three images, all from the first third of his story.
WHAT THE TEXT GIVES	The most fully drawn character in the Hebrew Bible, and the portrait isn't flattering. A gifted musician and a brilliant political operator. An outlaw whose men ask Nabal for payment. A king who dances before the ark and quarrels with Michal over it. A man who sees a woman from a roof, sends for her, and has her husband killed by written order. A father who does nothing when his son rapes his daughter, and nearly loses the kingdom to another son. On his deathbed he gives his heir a list of men to deal with.
WHAT DOMINION DOES	**POSSIBLE** Everything. Divinely chosen, anointed by a prophet, forgiven after private repentance and promised an eternal dynasty (2 Sam 7), the legal basis of every throne that ever called itself Christian. His crimes are taught as a lesson in personal repentance and never as a case for accountability.
TKC ECHOES	The Emperor, and the founding myth he's measured against. Judah, if he's being trained into a role built on a man whose worst acts are on the record and forgiven in advance.
WHERE IT BREAKS	A prophet walks into the throne room, tells him what he did, and lives. The scene is the difference between a monarchy with a conscience mechanism and one without. **OPEN QUESTION** Does anyone in Dorian's court have Nathan's office?

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

1 SAM 16 – 1 KGS 2

1 SAM 13.14

1 SAM 25

2 SAM 6

2 SAM 7

2 SAM 11–13

1 KGS 2.5–9

TKC: TL

1 SAM 8.11–18

2 SAM 12

1 KGS 1–11

1 KGS 9.20–22

1 KGS 12

1 KGS 17–19

JUDG 6–9

JER 26

JER 36

JER 38.7–13

EXOD 32

LEV 10

Kingmakers, prophets and priests

The oldest fight in the collection. The priest is appointed, hereditary and salaried. The prophet is called, unlicensed and unpaid.

SAMUEL	When the people ask for a king "like all the nations," he warns them what a king will take: sons for his chariots, daughters for his kitchens, the best fields, a tenth of the flocks, "and you shall be his slaves." He anoints one anyway, and later anoints the replacement while the first is still alive. The cleric who makes rulers and outlives them.
NATHAN	Delivers the dynastic promise, then tells David the story of the rich man and the poor man's lamb and says "You are the man." He survives, and later works with Bathsheba to put Solomon on the throne.
SOLOMON	Wins the succession and has rivals killed. His first judgment is between two women who are prostitutes, each claiming a baby, and he hears them both in person. He builds the temple with conscripted labor. 1 Kings 9 says the forced labor fell on non-Israelites, and 1 Kings 12 says the north revolted over his "heavy yoke," so the passages pull against each other. He breaks all four prohibitions of Deuteronomy 17.
GIDEON	Offered hereditary rule, he refuses: "The LORD will rule over you." Afterward he makes a gold ephod that becomes a snare. His son Abimelech kills seventy brothers to be king, and the survivor Jotham answers with the fable of the trees, where the olive, fig and vine all decline the crown and the bramble accepts it.

Kingmakers, prophets and priests, continued

ELIJAH	Confronts Ahab and Jezebel and wins on Carmel. Afterward he runs, asks to die, and is fed and told to sleep. God comes to him in "a sound of thin silence." Malachi promises his return. The King James New Testament spells him Elias.
JEREMIAH	Tried for his life, his scroll cut up and burned, dropped in a muddy cistern. A Cushite palace servant, Ebed-melech, gets the king's permission and pulls him out with ropes and rags.
AARON	The first high priest. He makes the calf, announces a feast to the LORD and says the gold went into the fire "and out came this calf." He keeps his office, joins Miriam's challenge and isn't struck.

1 SAM 8.11–18

2 SAM 12

1 KGS 1–11

1 KGS 9.20–22

1 KGS 12

1 KGS 17–19

JUDG 6–9

JER 26

JER 36

JER 38.7–13

EXOD 32

LEV 10

THE STRUCTURAL POINT FOR DOMINION

POSSIBLE When Dominion folded the prophet into the priest, it didn't abolish prophecy. It made prophecy an employment category, a far more elegant solution.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

MARK 8.32–33

JOHN 21.15–17

GAL 2.11–14

GAL 3.28

1 COR 14.34–35

JOHN 12.6

MATT 26.14–16

MATT 27.24

JOSEPHUS, ANT. 18.116–119

PILATE INSCRIPTION, CAESAREA (1961)

The men of the New Testament

The men closest to the center are shown getting it wrong again and again, and the record was kept by the movement they went on to lead.

PETER	Rebukes Jesus and is called "Satan." Cuts off a servant's ear in the garden. Denies knowing him three times, the first to a servant girl. Restored over breakfast with a question asked three times. Paul rebukes him in public at Antioch for withdrawing from gentile tables.
PAUL	A Pharisee who persecuted the movement and joined it. Imprisoned repeatedly, he writes that in Christ there is "no longer slave or free, no longer male and female," and greets women leaders by name.
JUDAS	Keeps the common purse. The gospels give different reasons for what he does. Matthew has him ask what they'll pay, John calls him a thief, Luke and John say Satan entered him. Matthew and Acts give two different deaths.
PILATE	The Roman prefect of Judea, 26–36 CE. All four gospels have him find no case and order the execution anyway. Only Matthew has him wash his hands. An inscription found at Caesarea in 1961 names him. **For TKC:** POSSIBLE: the Crown advisor in the Pairing Introduction (TR) is a Pilate.
JOHN THE BAPTIST	A priest's son preaching in the wilderness, who calls the crowds a "brood of vipers." Herod Antipas has him beheaded at a banquet. The gospels give a personal reason, his objection to Herod's marriage. Josephus gives a political one, Herod's fear of his hold on the crowds.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said the silencing verses and Galatians 3.28 are "both his." 1 Corinthians 14.34–35 sits elsewhere in some manuscripts and may be a later addition, and 1 Timothy's authorship is CONTESTED. It also said "one gospel implies disillusionment" for Judas. None does.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THESE MEN IS JUDAH, AND WHICH IS DORIAN

TKC: TL · TR · FR 0 · FR 3 · FR 33

DECIDED

The names in the cast

Many of the cast carry biblical names. The table records what each name points to. Whether an echo is meant is your call, so every application after this page is POSSIBLE unless it carries a source tag.

NAME	WHO IN TKC	BIBLICAL SOURCE
EDEN SELAH OSEI	Covenant Daughter of Aurem (**TL**)	The garden (Gen 2–3). *Selah* is a liturgical marker of unknown meaning, seventy-one times in Psalms and three in Habakkuk.
MIRIAM OSEI	Eden's mother (**TL**)	Miriam the prophet. Mariam in Greek, so every Mary in the New Testament.
LEAH OSEI	Eden's younger sister (TL, DECIDED)	Leah, the fertile, unloved wife (Gen 29–30)
ZION OSEI	Eden's brother (**TL**)	A place: Jerusalem's hill, and the city addressed as "daughter Zion"
SOLOMON OSEI	Eden's brother, sixteen (DECIDED)	Solomon, Bathsheba's son, born after the household broke
THOMAS OSEI	Eden's father, who left voluntarily (**FR 3**)	Thomas, who wouldn't believe without seeing (John 20)
HANNAH	House Mother, House Aurem (**TL**)	Hannah, who gave her only son to the sanctuary
NAOMI	Hannah's daughter (**TL**)	Naomi, who came home empty and planned Ruth's future
ABIGAIL	Debate and Protocol Advisor (**TL**)	Abigail, who talked an armed man out of a massacre on her knees

The names in the cast, continued

TKC: TL · TR · FR 0 · FR 3 · FR 33

DECIDED

NAME	WHO IN TKC	BIBLICAL SOURCE
RUTH GIDEON	Covenant Daughter of Heartland (TR)	Ruth, and Gideon, who refused a crown and made a snare
JUDAH ELIJAH VANE	Crown Heir (TL)	Judah, who offered himself in his brother's place. Elijah, who confronted a king and queen.
ELIAS VANE	Founder (TL)	Elias is the King James New Testament spelling of Elijah
ZARA VOSS	Covenant Daughter of Sable (TR)	Zara is the King James spelling of Zerah, Tamar's twin
SERA CALLUM VANE · SERA MONTOYA	Elias's wife (TL) · Covenant Daughter of Pacific (TR)	Serah, daughter of Asher, one of the few daughters named in the genealogies
PETRA SOLANO	Covenant Daughter of Mountain (TR)	A word: Greek *petra*, "rock" (Matt 16.18)
AZRAEL VANE	Dorian's elder son (TL)	No biblical source. The angel of death in later Islamic and Jewish tradition.

SUPERSEDED The timeline's age of thirteen for Solomon. **DECIDED** Solomon is sixteen, and Leah is younger than Eden.

TKC: TL · TR · DOM · DR3 · WR · AM · FR 26 · FR 29 · FR 41–42

ECHOES, LABELED

SEVEN WOMEN PROPHETS	The Talmud's list (Megillah 14a) is Sarah, Miriam, Deborah, Hannah, Abigail, Huldah and Esther. Eden's mother, her House Mother and her protocol advisor all carry prophets' names. **POSSIBLE** Celeste knows the list and has never said so.
ELIAS AS ELIJAH	**POSSIBLE** The Temple reads its canonized founder (**TL**) as the Elijah Malachi promised, and named the Crown Heir Judah Elijah to carry it. Elijah's story includes the collapse after the victory, and the Temple doesn't teach it.
HULDAH	The ledger and the Covenant of Dissent are found documents (**TL, FR 41–42**). **OPEN QUESTION** Who in the Empire would be asked to authenticate the Dissent if it surfaced?
TAMAR'S METHOD	**POSSIBLE** Eden's method in a world run by the Registry, and its limit. Tamar had a law on her side that wasn't enforced. Eden's law is against her.
JEZEBEL	Aurelia is built over Atlanta's Black memory, and Gulf candidates are penalized for warmth (**DOM**). **POSSIBLE** "Jezebel" is the word the Broadcast never says on air and its editors use in the room.
SAMUEL 8 AND JOTHAM'S FABLE	Two anti-monarchy texts in the Empire's own canon. **POSSIBLE** Pacific's grandmothers (**DOM**) know the bramble fable by heart.
EBED-MELECH	**POSSIBLE** Hannah, who knows the back staircases and the camera gaps (**TL**), is this kind of insider.
JEREMIAH'S SCROLL	Dorian removed the Covenant of Dissent (**FR 42**). **POSSIBLE** Someone can still recite it, the way Celeste can recite the Covenant of Purpose (**AM**).
JOHN THE BAPTIST	**INTERPRETATION** The Empire's "sudden medical event" for Azrael and Petra works the same way as the gospels' account of John, a private explanation for a public act.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE ECHO I'M KEEPING, AND THE ONE I'M CUTTING

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

PART IX LOG

Working Questions

1 · WHICH BIBLICAL NAMES IN THE CAST WERE CHOSEN BY A CHARACTER, AND WHICH BY THE REGISTRY? WHO NAMED LEAH, ZION AND SOLOMON?

2 · DOES HANNAH KNOW SHE'S NAMED FOR A WOMAN WHO GAVE HER CHILD TO THE SANCTUARY? DOES NAOMI?

3 · WHAT DOES ABIGAIL SAY TO EDEN THAT THE BIBLICAL ABIGAIL SAID TO DAVID?

4 · WRITE THE TEMPLE'S LESSON ON VASHTI FOR GIRLS AT DESIGNATION AGE, THEN THE VERSION CELESTE TOLD EDEN

Working Questions, Continued

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

PART IX LOG

5 · WHICH COVENANT DAUGHTER IN EARLIER TRIALS GOT THE MARY MAGDALENE TREATMENT, AND WHERE IS SHE NOW?

6 · DOES JUDAH KNOW THE END OF ELIJAH'S STORY, THE CAVE AND THE SILENCE? WHO TAUGHT IT TO HIM?

7 · WHICH BIBLICAL WOMAN DOES CELESTE NAME MOST OFTEN AT THE KITCHEN TABLE, AND WHICH ONE WON'T SHE TALK ABOUT?

III

PART THREE · ✝

Jesus, Kingdom and Power

The novel is named after a line from his prayer. Here's what he meant by it, and what the Empire has decided he meant.

i · What he meant by kingdom	411
ii · Four things he kept doing	413
iii · The Lord's Prayer, clause by clause	415
iv · The Gospel Grid	420
v · For TKC	431

What he meant by kingdom

Start with the word, because everything turns on it. *Basileia* means kingdom, kingship or reign, and it's the word for the empire that ruled Judea. "The kingdom of God" is the center of his preaching in the first three gospels. Mark's summary is "The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God has come near." Matthew usually says "kingdom of heaven," a reverent way of not saying God, and means the same thing. He wasn't inventing a private spiritual category. He was making a claim about who governs, in a province where saying so got people crucified along the roads.

What he poured into that political word runs against what the word normally carries. The parables describe the kingdom as small, hidden and growing without permission: a mustard seed, yeast in flour, treasure buried in a field, a merchant who sells everything for one pearl. It belongs to the poor. Children, tax collectors and prostitutes go in ahead of the respectable, and it's harder for the rich to enter than for a camel to go through a needle's eye. Rank is turned over on purpose. When his followers argue about who's greatest he tells them the rulers of the nations lord it over their subjects, "but it shall not be so among you." In John he washes their feet, a slave's work. When a crowd wants to make him king by force he withdraws. He enters Jerusalem on a donkey. **INTERPRETATION** Marcus Borg and John Dominic Crossan read the entry as a counter-procession to the Roman governor's arrival with troops at Passover. The charge on the cross, in all four gospels, is "King of the Jews." CONTESTED: Whether the kingdom is present, future or both. Albert Schweitzer argued in 1906 that Jesus expected the end of the world soon, C. H. Dodd argued in 1935 that the kingdom was already present in his ministry, and most scholars now hold some version of "already and not yet." Luke 17.21 says the kingdom is *entos hymōn*, "within you" or "among you," and the translation turns it from an inner state into a present reality in a community.

> *The rulers of the nations lord it over them. It shall not be so among you.*
> MATT 20.25–26

NT | KINGDOM

TWO SAYINGS THE EMPIRE NEEDS

"My kingdom is not of this world" (John 18.36). **CONTESTED** *Ek tou kosmou toutou* is "from this world," and many read it as a statement about the kingdom's source more than its location. "Render to Caesar" (Mark 12.13–17) answers a trap about Roman tax. He asks whose image is on the coin. **CONTESTED** Two spheres, an evasion, or a challenge, since his hearers know whose image human beings bear (Gen 1.27).

MARGINALIA

✤ *See also:* For TKC, at the end of this part.

YOURS

TKC: TL

AM

What Dominion teaches the kingdom is

THE RELOCATION

POSSIBLE The Temple empties the word. The kingdom becomes an inner condition of the obedient heart or a reward after death, anywhere but here and never a claim on territory. Having emptied it, the Empire claims the word for itself: Dominion is the kingdom come, which makes resisting the state the same as resisting God. The old companion called this the engine of the novel (AM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES THE KINGDOM IS, IN ITS OWN WORDS

A SCENE WHERE THE SAME LINE IS SAID TWICE, BY TWO PEOPLE MEANING OPPOSITE THINGS

Four things he kept doing

AUTHORITY	Crowds say he teaches "as one who had authority, and not as the scribes," and officials keep asking "By what authority are you doing these things?" He argues sabbath practice, calls scribes and Pharisees "blind guides" and "whitewashed tombs," and drives the money changers out of the temple court. **For TKC:** POSSIBLE: unlicensed authority is the crime Dominion can't forgive, since it's the only one that threatens the licensing system itself.
BODIES	He touches a man with a skin disease and takes a dead girl by the hand. The bleeding woman touches him first, without asking, and he commends her faith. INTERPRETATION The contagion runs the other way. He doesn't become unclean, and they become well. CONTESTED Whether that amounts to opposing the purity system. Paula Fredriksen and Amy-Jill Levine warn that reading Jesus as against Jewish law is a Christian habit with an ugly history. He sends the healed man to the priest with the offering Moses commanded.
WOMEN	Mary of Bethany sits at his feet in the student's place, and he defends her. Named women fund the movement. A Syrophoenician woman argues with him over healing her daughter, answers his refusal with "even the dogs under the table eat the children's crumbs," and he grants it "for this saying." She wins the exchange. He's anointed by a woman in a room of men who call it waste. No gospel records him telling a woman to be silent.
MONEY	He tells a rich man to sell everything, and the man goes away grieving. Luke pairs blessings on the poor with woes on the rich and adds the rich fool and the rich man and Lazarus. In his first sermon, at Nazareth, he reads Isaiah 61, "release to the captives... the year of the Lord's favor," which echoes the Jubilee, and says it's fulfilled today. **For TKC:** INTERPRETATION: The most suppressed material in Dominion's scripture is economic more than sexual. Follow the money and you'll find the censorship.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said the Nazareth room "turns on him" over the year of release. The congregation first speaks well of him (4.22). They try to throw him off a cliff after he says Elijah and Elisha were sent to foreigners, a widow of Sidon and a Syrian general (4.24–30).

MARK 1.22

MARK 11.28

MATT 23

MARK 11.15–17

MARK 1.41–44

MARK 5.25–34

MARK 7.24–30

LUKE 8.1–3

LUKE 10.38–42

MARK 10.17–22

LUKE 4.16–30

FREDRIKSEN

LEVINE, THE MISUNDERSTOOD JEW (2006)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

Thy kingdom come

MATT 6.7–13

LUKE 11.1–4

P75

CODEX VATICANUS

CODEX SINAITICUS

DIDACHE 8.2

The prayer appears twice, in different settings and forms. In Matthew it's part of the Sermon on the Mount, taught in place of heaping up empty phrases. In Luke the disciples ask "Lord, teach us to pray," and he gives a shorter version. Every pronoun for the people praying is plural. There's no "I" in it.

CLAUSE	MATTHEW 6.9–13	LUKE 11.2–4	COMMON LITURGICAL FORM
ADDRESS	Our Father in heaven	Father	Our Father, who art in heaven
NAME	Hallowed be your name	Hallowed be your name	Hallowed be thy name
KINGDOM	Your kingdom come	Your kingdom come	Thy kingdom come
WILL	Your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven	Absent in the earliest manuscripts	Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven
BREAD	Give us this day our daily bread	Give us each day our daily bread	Give us this day our daily bread
FORGIVENESS	Forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors	Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves forgive everyone indebted to us	Forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us
TESTING	Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil (or "the evil one")	Lead us not into temptation	Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil
DOXOLOGY	Absent in the earliest manuscripts	Absent	For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion presented one prayer and treated "on earth as in heaven" as part of the title line. "Thy kingdom come" is in both gospels. "On earth as in heaven" is Matthew's alone, the doxology is a later addition, and the prayer most people recite is Matthew's text with a liturgical ending.

KADDISH

EPIOUSIOS

JEROME, VULGATE

TYNDALE (1526)

BOOK OF COMMON PRAYER (1549)

MATT 6.14–15

Clause by clause

OUR FATHER IN HEAVEN	A shared parent makes the people praying siblings, and rank inside the family a fiction. INTERPRETATION Authority is placed where no earthly office can occupy it. POSSIBLE Dominion prefers the clause said upward and never sideways.
HALLOWED BE YOUR NAME	A request that God's name be treated as holy. INTERPRETATION It implies no other name is, imperial or dynastic. Ask what Dominion has carved above its doors.
YOUR KINGDOM COME	The title line, in both gospels. It asks for the kingdom's arrival, which assumes it isn't fully here. The Jewish Kaddish, an Aramaic prayer whose core many date early, also pairs the hallowing of God's name with a prayer that the kingdom come soon, and the two are often compared.
YOUR WILL BE DONE, ON EARTH AS IN HEAVEN	Matthew's. It's absent from Luke in the earliest manuscripts (P75, Codex Vaticanus) and was added by later copyists. INTERPRETATION In Matthew it ties the kingdom to the earth, to the place where taxes are collected and soldiers are stationed.
OUR DAILY BREAD	*Epiousios*, "daily," appears nowhere in Greek before the gospels, and its meaning is uncertain: "for today," "for tomorrow," "necessary for existence." Jerome translated it two ways, "supersubstantial" in Matthew and "daily" in Luke. It asks for enough, and for "our" bread more than "my" bread.

Clause by clause, continued

FORGIVE US OUR DEBTS	Matthew says debts, *opheilēmata*. Luke says sins, though his second half keeps the debt language. Both tie the request to the one praying it. "Trespasses" isn't in either gospel's prayer. It comes from Tyndale's Matthew (1526) and the Book of Common Prayer (1549), and passed into Anglican and Catholic English. Matthew's very next verses do use a word for trespasses.
LEAD US NOT INTO TEMPTATION	*Peirasmos* means testing or trial as well as temptation. **INTERPRETATION** A request to be spared the test, more than to pass it heroically. Pope Francis criticized the wording in 2017, and the French and Italian Catholic liturgies changed it. "From evil" can also be "from the evil one."
FOR THINE IS THE KINGDOM	Absent from the earliest manuscripts of Matthew and from every early Luke. A shorter form appears in the Didache, about 100 CE. Later manuscripts added it, the King James printed it, and most modern translations footnote it.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said institutions render the clause "trespasses" to blunt its money sense. Debts, sins and trespasses track which text and translation tradition a church inherited, and they aren't evidence of motive. Churches that say "debts," Presbyterian and Reformed ones among them, follow the King James Matthew.

KADDISH

EPIOUSIOS

JEROME, VULGATE

TYNDALE (1526)

BOOK OF COMMON PRAYER (1549)

MATT 6.14–15

WRITING

TKC: DR3 · TL

OPEN QUESTION

Dominion's version

INFERENCE The Book of Covenant uses King James wording (**DR3**), so the Temple's base text is probably Matthew 6 as the KJV prints it: "debts," "Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven," and the doxology. **OPEN QUESTION** Does the Temple say "debts" or "trespasses" in public worship, and does it print Luke's shorter version anywhere?

DOMINION'S OFFICIAL TEXT, LINE BY LINE. WHAT'S CUT, WHAT'S ADDED

WHO IN THE CAST SAYS "DEBTS" AND WHO SAYS "TRESPASSES," AND DOES ANYONE NOTICE?

The line, in the house

WRITING

TKC: TL

Elias Vane's 2033 sermon is called Thy Kingdom Come, and it's been required curriculum in every Dominion school since 2061 (TL).

THE PASSAGE OF ELIAS'S SERMON THAT EXPLAINS WHAT "THY KINGDOM COME" MEANS. THE LINE EVERY SCHOOLCHILD KNOWS

WHAT CELESTE SAYS THE LINE MEANS, AT THE KITCHEN TABLE, WHEN EDEN IS SMALL

SOURCE MARGIN

MATT · MARK · LUKE · JOHN

NA28 · UBS5

SANDERS, THE HISTORICAL FIGURE OF JESUS (1993)

EHRMAN, THE NEW TESTAMENT

Luke 1.1–3

Many have undertaken to compile a narrative of the things that have been accomplished among us…

it seemed good to me also, having followed all things closely for some time past, to write an orderly account for you.

✣

A gospel that opens by saying there were others. Four, kept side by side.

REFERENCE UNIT · ◈

The Gospel Grid

There's no single gospel. There are four, written for different communities decades apart, and they disagree about the order of events, the wording of the sayings, the day of the death and what happened at the tomb. This unit holds all four at once.

WHY A GRID AND NOT A HARMONY

A harmony stitches the four into one story and quietly deletes the differences. The differences are the most useful material in the New Testament for a writer. They show four groups deciding what mattered.

WHAT THIS UNIT WON'T DO

Tell you which account is right, whether the differences are contradictions or perspectives, or what any of it obliges you to believe. Every date and source theory is marked as argued.

The record on each

All four are formally anonymous. The names were attached by tradition, generally in the second century. Every date is a mainstream range, and every one is argued.

	MARK	MATTHEW	LUKE	JOHN
USUAL DATE	About 65–75	About 80–90	About 80–95	About 90–110
LENGTH	16 chapters, the shortest	28 chapters	24 chapters, continued in Acts	21 chapters
OPENS WITH	John the Baptist in the wilderness	A genealogy from Abraham	A dedication claiming orderly research	"In the beginning was the Word," before creation
BIRTH STORY	None	Magi, Herod's massacre, flight to Egypt	Shepherds, Mary's song, the temple	None
GENEALOGY	None	Abraham to Joseph, naming Tamar, Rahab, Ruth and "the wife of Uriah"	Back to Adam, by a different line after David	None
TEACHING	Short, often private explanations	Five large blocks, the Sermon on the Mount first	The Sermon on the Plain, the most parables	Long first-person discourses, the "I am" sayings
EXORCISMS	Central	Frequent	Frequent	None
LEANS TOWARD	Disciples who don't understand. His identity is named at the cross by a Roman soldier.	Fulfillment, the law, community discipline, judgment	The poor, reversals of status, women, foreigners	Who Jesus is, and belief

MARK 1.1

MATT 1.1

LUKE 1.1–4

JOHN 1.1

JOHN 20.31

PAPIAS (2ND C.)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE FOUR VOICES IS CLOSEST TO HOW MY WORLD TELLS ITS OWN FOUNDING STORY

The record on each, continued

MARK 15.34

MATT 27.46

LUKE 23.34, 46

JOHN 19.30

MARK 16.8

MARK 16.9–20

	MARK	MATTHEW	LUKE	JOHN
LORD'S PRAYER	Absent	6.9–13	11.2–4	Absent
MINISTRY	Can be read as about a year, one trip to Jerusalem	Same	Same	Three Passovers and several trips, the source of "three years"
TEMPLE ACTION	Final week, the trigger for the arrest	Final week	Final week	At the start (ch. 2)
LAST MEAL	A Passover meal	A Passover meal	A Passover meal	Before Passover. He dies as the lambs are slaughtered.
LAST WORDS	"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" then a loud cry	The same cry	"Father, into your hands I commit my spirit"	"It is finished"
AT THE TOMB	Three women, the stone rolled away, a young man inside. They flee and tell no one.	Two Marys, an earthquake, an angel, guards. They meet Jesus on the way.	Several named women, two men in dazzling clothes. The apostles think it's nonsense.	Mary Magdalene, then Peter and another disciple. Jesus appears to her first.
ENDING	The earliest manuscripts end at 16.8 with the women afraid. The longer ending is a later addition.	A commission on a mountain in Galilee	Appearances near Jerusalem, the ascension	Two endings, 20.30–31 and ch. 21

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said "no two of the four give the same last words." Mark and Matthew give the same cry, Eloi in Mark and Eli in Matthew. Luke's "Father, forgive them" (23.34) is missing from some of the earliest manuscripts, and its originality is CONTESTED.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH ENDING MY WORLD'S FOUNDING ACCOUNT USES, AND WHO CUT THE OTHERS

The overlap problem

Matthew, Mark and Luke run parallel closely enough to print in columns, same episodes, same order, sometimes identical Greek for long stretches. Independent memory doesn't do that. Some literary relationship is certain. **CONTESTED** Which one.

PROPOSAL	WHAT IT CLAIMS	ITS WEAK POINT
TWO-SOURCE, THE MAJORITY VIEW	Matthew and Luke each used Mark, plus a lost sayings collection called Q, plus material of their own	Q has never been found and is reconstructed from the texts it explains
FARRER · GOODACRE (2002)	Luke used Mark and Matthew both, so no lost source is needed	It has to explain why Luke broke up Matthew's sermons and moved the pieces
MATTHEW FIRST · GRIESBACH	Matthew is earliest, and Mark condensed the others	It has to explain why a condenser would add rough Greek and unflattering details
JOHN	Knew the other three, knew a tradition behind them, or wrote independently. A separate dispute.	Its differences are too large to be editorial trimming

ONLY IN MARK	A healing that takes two tries, a young man who runs away naked at the arrest, and the abrupt ending at the empty tomb.
ONLY IN MATTHEW	The magi, the massacre of the children, the guard at the tomb, and the sheep and the goats.
ONLY IN LUKE	The shepherds, Mary's song, the good Samaritan, the prodigal son, the rich man and Lazarus, the road to Emmaus. Most of what's quoted about poverty and mercy is his.
ONLY IN JOHN	Cana, Nicodemus at night, the Samaritan woman, Lazarus raised, the foot washing and the long farewell.

THE FINDING THAT MATTERS FOR TKC

INTERPRETATION Whatever the order, later writers visibly edited earlier ones, softening, reordering, adding a birth and adding an ending. Scripture inside the canon is visibly revised scripture. An empire that claims a fixed, unedited text is claiming something its own documents contradict, and that's a device as much as a polemic.

MARK 8.22–26

MARK 14.51–52

MATT 2

MATT 25.31–46

LUKE 1.46–55

JOHN 11

GOODACRE, THE CASE AGAINST Q (2002)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO EDITED THE FOUNDING ACCOUNT IN MY WORLD, AND WHAT THEY SOFTENED

Run any episode through it

Pick an episode that appears in more than one gospel and fill the columns from the text, not from memory. Good starters: the temple action, the anointing, the trial before Pilate, the words from the cross, the empty tomb.

EPISODE	TRANSLATION USED

GOSPEL	REFERENCE AND WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT'S ADDED, MISSING OR CHANGED
Mark		
Matthew		
Luke		
John		

THE DIFFERENCE THAT ACTUALLY CHANGES THE MEANING, AND WHOSE INTEREST IT SERVES

WHICH VERSION MY WORLD WOULD CANONIZE, AND WHICH IT WOULD SUPPRESS

JOHN 2.13–22

JOHN 19.14–31

MATT 1 · LUKE 3

MATT 5 · LUKE 6

MATT 6 · LUKE 11

MARK 16 · JOHN 20

Where they don't match

These are differences in the text. Whether they're contradictions or complementary perspectives is a theological judgment this companion leaves to you. Their being differences isn't in dispute.

THE TEMPLE ACTION	In the first three it happens in the final week and triggers the arrest. In John it opens the ministry. Same event, opposite role.
THE DAY OF DEATH	The first three make the last meal a Passover meal. John puts the crucifixion before the Passover meal, so the death coincides with the slaughter of the lambs.
THE GENEALOGIES	Matthew and Luke give different lines with different names between David and Joseph, running in opposite directions. Reconciliations have been proposed, and none commands agreement.
AFTER THE BIRTH	Matthew has a flight to Egypt to escape a massacre. Luke has a calm presentation at the temple and a return to Nazareth. The two itineraries are hard to run at once.
THE BEATITUDES	Matthew sets them on a mountain and blesses the poor in spirit. Luke sets them on level ground, blesses the poor, and adds matching woes on the rich. One is interior and one is economic.
THE PRAYER	Luke's is shorter, and the familiar closing line is missing from the oldest manuscripts of both. The prayer most recited in the world is a composite.
AT THE TOMB	The number of women, the number of figures, whether the stone is already moved, who's told, Galilee or Jerusalem, and whether anyone speaks all differ. Women are the first witnesses in every one.

THE ONE DETAIL THEY ALL KEEP

INTERPRETATION Four accounts that agree on almost no logistics all put women at the tomb first, in a culture where women's testimony carried little legal weight. Some scholars argue an inventing community wouldn't have chosen it. It's an argument from plausibility and not a proof.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHOSE TESTIMONY MY WORLD REFUSES TO COUNT, AND WHAT THEY SAW ANYWAY

WRITING

UNIT CLOSE

QUEUE: G0

What I take out of the grid

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN TWO ACCOUNTS THAT I'M PUTTING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT

WHICH GOSPEL THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES MOST, AND WHY THAT ONE

WHAT I STILL NEED TO CHECK. CARRY IT TO THE RESEARCH LIST.

PROOFING GATE *log only, nothing is closed here*

The Gospel Grid has six numbered pages. Source theories and dates are carried as CONTESTED. Textual facts about manuscript endings are research. Outstanding for proofing: full citations with edition and year.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

The prayer and the Trials

TKC: TL · DR3 · TR · DOM · CR · WR · AM

THE TITLE, TWICE	Elias Vane's 2033 sermon is called Thy Kingdom Come (**TL**), and the novel takes the same words. **INTERPRETATION** Every character who prays the line is asking either for the Empire to last or for something to replace it, and may not know which.
RELOCATING THE KINGDOM	**POSSIBLE** The Temple makes "My kingdom is not of this world" its favorite verse and then names the Empire as the kingdom come. The move needs both halves, the kingdom emptied of territory and the Empire claiming the territory.
ON EARTH AS IN HEAVEN	**POSSIBLE** The clause the Temple can't spiritualize, because it names the earth. Someone who's read Luke knows the prayer works without it, and someone who's read Matthew knows it doesn't.
DEBTS AND LEVIES	In Aurem, families of the top five Assessment finishers get the kind of review where unpaid levies disappear (**DR3**). **INTERPRETATION** The Empire forgives a household's debts in exchange for its daughter. **POSSIBLE** A character notices the Temple says "trespasses" in the same building as the levy office.
LEAD US NOT INTO TESTING	**INTERPRETATION** Twelve Covenant Daughters pray every week to be spared the test while the Empire tests them for four months. **POSSIBLE** The Temple teaches the clause as a prayer for the strength to pass.
WOMEN AT THE TOMB	Eden's Theological Interview report runs three pages longer than anyone else's, and the officer can't tell whether she's the most aligned woman in twenty years or the most clear-eyed (**TR**). **POSSIBLE** Whose testimony counts is the Trials' question too.
THE SYROPHOENICIAN WOMAN	**POSSIBLE** The precedent for Eden's Public Testimony, where every sentence is defensible and the whole is incendiary (**TR**).

TKC: DOM · CR · TR · WR 36 · WR 38–39

The Procession and the Broadcast

THE DONKEY AND THE BOULEVARD	The Opening Procession gives Aurem's Covenant Daughter forty-seven seconds on Sovereign Boulevard (**DOM**), and every walk is choreographed (**CR**). **POSSIBLE** Someone knows the entry into Jerusalem was read as a parody of a governor's procession, and walks the Boulevard thinking about it.
RANK TURNED OVER	**POSSIBLE** Judah knows Mark 10.42–44, and it's part of why he doesn't perform (**WR 36**). In the Pairing Introduction he sends the officials out (**TR**), the closest thing in the Trials to washing feet.
FOUR GOSPELS AND ONE BROADCAST	The Broadcast edits the Civic Debates for Dominion release, cutting exchanges and building narratives decided in advance (**TR**). **INTERPRETATION** The gospels show four communities shaping one story, openly and in the canon. The Broadcast does it in secret and calls the result the record.
KEEPING THE ANTI-JEWISH TROPE OUT	The Temple of TKC is the Empire's institution. When Jesus argues with Pharisees and scribes, the argument is inside first-century Judaism. If the novel uses those scenes against the Temple, the narration has to know the difference, or it repeats an old Christian slander (**WR 38–39**).
LUKE 4	**POSSIBLE** The Temple preaches the release of Luke 4.18 as spiritual and drops 4.25–27, since favor to outsiders is what the Empire can't afford in any Dominion.

THE SCENE I'M BUILDING FROM THIS PAGE

Working questions

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

PART IX LOG

1 · WHICH OF THE FOUR GOSPELS DOES THE TEMPLE READ FROM MOST, AND WHICH IS ALMOST NEVER READ ALOUD?

2 · DOES THE TEMPLE TEACH THAT MARK ENDS AT 16.8? WOULD A GIRL WITH EDEN'S SCORES HAVE FOUND OUT ON HER OWN?

3 · WHO IN THE CROWNWARD HAS READ THE MAGNIFICAT AS A POLITICAL TEXT, AND WHAT HAPPENED TO THEM?

4 · WHICH SAYING OF JESUS WOULD GET A COVENANT DAUGHTER FLAGGED IF SHE QUOTED IT IN THE CIVIC DEBATES?

5 · WHEN EDEN PRAYS "LEAD US NOT INTO TEMPTATION" DURING THE TRIALS, WHAT DOES SHE MEAN BY IT?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

6 · WHAT DOES THE EMPIRE DO WITH "THE RULERS OF THE NATIONS LORD IT OVER THEM"? WHAT IS JUDAH'S PRIVATE READING OF "MY KINGDOM IS NOT OF THIS WORLD"?

IV

PART FOUR · ▣

Empire and Interpretation

No empire in this literature ever had to change a word of scripture. It only had to decide which words were read aloud, to whom, and how often.

i · Empires of the Bible 436

ii · Who gets to say what it means 438

iii · Passages put to work 440

iv · Passages kept quiet 442

v · American history, 1630 to now 444

vi · For TKC 456

EXOD 1–14

2 KGS 17–19

2 KGS 18.26–28

2 KGS 24–25

DAN 1.3–7

EZRA 1, 6–7

ESTH 1–2

ESTH 8.8

DAN 6.8

TKC: MEN · TL

Five occupations

Almost the whole Bible was written by people living under someone else's government. Read the empires as a menu of methods, because Dominion uses some combination of them.

EGYPT · LABOR	Forced labor, rising quotas and a decree controlling births. Unrest is answered with more work. Its method is exhaustion, people too tired to organize. Read Exodus 1–14.
ASSYRIA · SUBMISSION, ADVERTISED	Terror and deportation. Conquered peoples were broken up and resettled among strangers, and the northern kingdom disappeared this way. Its envoy shouts terms at Jerusalem's wall in the local language so the people on the wall can hear. Read 2 Kings 17–19 and Nahum.
BABYLON · THE TOP OF A SOCIETY	It deported the educated and skilled, trained young men in its own language and literature, renamed them and gave them careers, and left the poor to work the land. It also besieged Jerusalem, burned the temple and blinded the king, so it used both methods. Read 2 Kings 24–25, Daniel 1–6 and Lamentations.
PERSIA · ORDER AT LOW COST	Licensed and funded local religion. It sent the exiles home, paid for the temple and authorized its law. Its decrees can't be revoked. Its court gathers young women by search and removes a queen by legislation. Read Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther and Daniel 6.
ROME · TAXES AND QUIET	Governed through local clients, a client king, a temple aristocracy and a governor who signs orders he disagrees with. Crucifixion was public and slow, by roads. The emperor was honored as divine and his rule called peace. Read the gospels, Acts and Revelation.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion called Babylon's elite capture "far cheaper than terror," as if it chose one. It used both (2 Kgs 25.7–9).

THE COMPOSITE FOR DOMINION

POSSIBLE The Empire uses the cheap methods, Babylon's elite capture, Persia's licensed religion and Rome's local clients. The Imperial Education Track takes exceptional common boys and makes them Crown-adjacent for life (**MEN**), which is Daniel 1. Terror is kept for the edges: the Ungoverned, Azrael, the 2061 removal (**TL, FR 35–36**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH METHODS DOMINION USES, AND ON WHOM

TYNDALE (D. 1536)

GENEVA BIBLE (1560)

SLAVE BIBLE (1807)

SOUTH CAROLINA NEGRO ACT (1740)

NAT TURNER (1831)

TKC: DR3 · DOM

Seven separate powers

Authority over a text is a set of separate powers, usually held by different people. A religious state becomes total when one institution holds all of them. Work out which ones Dominion holds, because the ones it doesn't are where the plot lives.

POWER	WHAT IT DECIDES	HISTORICAL CASE
THE CANON	Which books count	Settled for most churches long ago, and so invisible
THE TRANSLATION	Which words	William Tyndale was executed in 1536, in part for translating the Bible into English without license
THE LECTIONARY	Which passages are read aloud, on which days	Most worshippers hear only what the calendar of readings allows
THE COMMENTARY	What a passage is taken to mean	The Geneva Bible's margin notes (1560) were one reason James I wanted a new translation without them
THE PULPIT	Who may stand up and speak	The licensing of preachers, and its withdrawal
THE COPY	Who owns a book, and which edition	Abridged editions like the 1807 Slave Bible
LITERACY	Who can read it unaided	South Carolina's Negro Act of 1740 banned teaching enslaved people to write, and several Southern states tightened anti-literacy laws after Nat Turner's revolt in 1831

> **THE HISTORICAL PATTERN**
>
> INTERPRETATION Movements that broke a religious monopoly usually did it by attacking translation, literacy or the copy. Reform tends to arrive as a printing problem before it's a theological one.

WHAT THE EMPIRE HOLDS

The pulpit (the Temple and its ministers), the lectionary (what's read before the scores, DR3), the commentary (the Assessment's doctrine section, DR3) and much of literacy (the Designation, DOM). OPEN QUESTION Does it hold the translation and the copy? Is the Book of Covenant a full Bible, and who may own another one?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE SEVEN DOMINION DOESN'T CONTROL, AND WHO IN THE CAST HAS QUIETLY TAKEN IT

GEN 3.16

ROM 13.1–7

EPH 5.21–22

1 TIM 2.11–12

DEUT 28

JOSH 7

NUM 16

JUDG 21.25

2 SAM 7

THE STATE'S WORKING TOOLKIT

Every one of these is in the text, and each has been read more narrowly or more widely than the text requires.

PASSAGE	HOW IT'S BEEN USED	WHAT THE TEXT DOES
GENESIS 3.16	As a charter for male rule in the household and the law	**CONTESTED** Prescription or description. The woman isn't cursed in the chapter.
ROMANS 13.1–7	As a demand to obey whatever government holds power. Loyalist clergy preached it against the American Revolution, and in June 2018 the U.S. attorney general cited it to defend a border policy that separated children from their parents.	Written by a man repeatedly jailed by the authorities he describes, in a canon full of prophets defying kings
EPHESIANS 5.22	As household law	Grows out of 5.21, "submit to one another," and is followed by a longer section demanding self-giving from husbands
1 TIMOTHY 2.11–12	As a permanent ban on women teaching	CONTESTED authorship. Named women teach elsewhere in the New Testament.
DEUTERONOMY 28	As a national scoreboard: prosperity proves virtue, disaster proves sin	One side of an argument the Bible has with itself. Job and Ecclesiastes refuse it.
JOSHUA 7	As a case for collective punishment	Set against Deuteronomy 24.16 and Ezekiel 18
NUMBERS 16	As the standing sermon against challenging ordained leaders	Paired in the same book with the daughters of Zelophehad, whose petition succeeds
2 SAMUEL 7	As a promise of an eternal dynasty	Followed in the same book by "You are the man"

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion called Genesis 3.16 "a curse, not a command." The woman isn't cursed, and whether the line is a command is the disputed point.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THESE IS CARVED ON A DOMINION WALL

LEV 25

DEUT 17

NUM 27

1 SAM 8

1 KGS 21

2 KGS 22

AMOS 5

EZEK 18 · 34

LUKE 1.46–55

LUKE 4.16–30

MATT 23

REV 18

What can't be read aloud

PASSAGE	WHY IT CAN'T BE READ ALOUD
LEVITICUS 25	Land returned every fiftieth year and Israelites in debt service freed, by law. Among the most economically dangerous chapters in scripture.
DEUTERONOMY 15	Debts released every seventh year, and the freed servant sent off with provisions
DEUTERONOMY 17	Limits on the king: no hoard of horses, wives or silver, and the law copied in his own hand
NUMBERS 27	Five women petition to change inheritance law, and God rules for them
1 SAMUEL 8	God's own warning, itemized, of what a monarchy will take from you
1 KINGS 21	The state kills a man for his land by correct procedure, and a prophet calls it murder to the king's face
2 KINGS 22	Officials take a found scroll to a woman, and the whole reform proceeds on her word
AMOS 5	God refuses the festivals and calls the worship music noise while injustice goes on
EZEKIEL 18 · 34	Guilt isn't inherited, and the shepherds are indicted for feeding themselves
LUKE 1.46–55	The Magnificat. Thrones emptied and the rich sent away, sung in the past tense
LUKE 4.16–30	Release for captives, and a congregation that turns on him for naming foreigners
MATTHEW 23	A whole chapter denouncing religious leaders by title
REVELATION 18	An empire falls, and the merchants weep because their trade is ruined

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old list had Leviticus 25 cancelling debts. The Jubilee returns land and frees Israelites in debt service. The debt release is Deuteronomy 15, added here.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH ONE SHE FINDS FIRST

1630 | 1961 | 1989

FOR TKC

The Covenant Coalition's platform was "America was great when it was godly. Return to God. Return to greatness" (TL). **INTERPRETATION** The Coalition reads Winthrop the way later politicians did and drops his point, that a covenant people is watched and judged by its failures. **POSSIBLE** Elias's 2033 sermon quotes "choose life" and Deuteronomy 30 together.

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Deep dive IV, Deuteronomy, page 13.

THE CITY ON A HILL

The Puritans who settled Massachusetts Bay in 1630 understood their colony as a community bound to God by covenant, on the model of Israel in Deuteronomy. Blessing would follow faithfulness, and judgment would follow breach. "A Model of Christian Charity" is traditionally attributed to John Winthrop and dated to 1630, given aboard or beside the Arbella. **CONTESTED** Some scholars suggest another minister wrote it, and it wasn't printed until 1838.

It says the colony "shall be as a city upon a hill," borrowing Matthew 5.14, and its point is that the whole world will watch, so failure will be public. It closes by paraphrasing Deuteronomy 30: "Therefore let us choose life." Daniel Rodgers (*As a City on a Hill*, 2018) argues the sermon was little known until the twentieth century. John F. Kennedy quoted it to the Massachusetts legislature as president-elect on January 9, 1961. Ronald Reagan made "a shining city upon a hill" a theme of his speeches and the center of his farewell address on January 11, 1989, adding the word "shining." INTERPRETATION: In Winthrop's use the image is a warning about being watched. In later political use it became a description of national greatness.

One Bible, two readings of slavery

Both sides of the American slavery debate read the same Bible and claimed it.

THE PROSLAVERY CASE	Noah's curse on Canaan, read as a curse on Africans. The permanent slavery of foreigners in Leviticus 25.44–46. Abraham's household slaves. The instructions to slaves in Ephesians 6.5, Colossians 3.22 and 1 Peter 2.18. Paul sending Onesimus back in Philemon. And the claim that Jesus never condemned slavery.
RICHARD FURMAN	After the Denmark Vesey plot in Charleston in 1822, the Baptist minister wrote an exposition, dated that December, for the South Carolina Baptist Convention defending slavery from scripture. Southern defenders used its arguments until the Civil War.
THORNTON STRINGFELLOW	A Virginia Baptist pastor who published *A Brief Examination of Scripture Testimony on the Institution of Slavery* (Richmond, 1841).
THE ABOLITIONIST ANSWER	The Golden Rule, "God made of one blood all nations" (Acts 17.26, KJV), "there is neither bond nor free" (Gal 3.28), the capital law against kidnapping a person to sell (Exod 21.16), the refusal to return runaways (Deut 23.15–16), and the exodus itself.
ANGELINA GRIMKÉ	From a South Carolina slaveholding family, she published *An Appeal to the Christian Women of the South* (1836) through the American Anti-Slavery Society and made the Bible her test.
FREDERICK DOUGLASS	Added an appendix to his *Narrative* (1845) to make clear his attacks were on "the slaveholding religion of this land," which he set against "the Christianity of Christ."

> **THE CRISIS UNDERNEATH**
>
> Mark Noll argues the war exposed a crisis in how Protestants read the Bible. Both sides held scripture to be authoritative and plain, and neither could persuade the other from it.

GEN 9.25

LEV 25.44–46

EPH 6.5

COL 3.22

1 PET 2.18

PHILEMON

FURMAN, EXPOSITION (1822)

STRINGFELLOW, BRIEF EXAMINATION (1841)

NOLL, THE CIVIL WAR AS A THEOLOGICAL CRISIS (2006)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH PROSLAVERY ARGUMENT THE EMPIRE STILL TEACHES, UNDER A DIFFERENT NAME AND ABOUT A DIFFERENT GROUP

The Churches Split, and the Slave Bible

THE SPLIT	Methodists divided in 1844. The Southern Baptist Convention was founded in Augusta, Georgia, in 1845, after the national Baptist mission board refused to appoint slaveholders as missionaries. Presbyterians divided in stages, finally in 1861. In June 1995, meeting in Atlanta, the Southern Baptist Convention adopted a resolution repenting of its past racism and apologizing to African Americans.
THE 1807 "SLAVE BIBLE"	A London missionary society published *Select Parts of the Holy Bible, for the Use of the Negro Slaves, in the British West-India Islands*. According to Anthony Schmidt of the Museum of the Bible, it kept 232 of the 1,189 chapters in a standard Protestant Bible, leaving out about ninety percent of the Old Testament and about half the New. The exodus is gone. Passages that reinforce slavery, Ephesians 6.5 among them, are kept. A copy on loan from Fisk University was shown at the museum in 2018–2019. The name "Slave Bible" is modern.

Select Parts of the Holy Bible

LONDON, 1807

FOR THE USE OF THE NEGRO SLAVES IN THE BRITISH WEST-INDIA ISLANDS

CHAPTERS KEPT	*232 of 1,189*
EXODUS	*removed*
EPHESIANS 6.5	*kept. "Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters."*
GALATIANS 3.28	*removed*

INTERPRETATION *The clearest case on record of controlling scripture without changing a word, by deciding which words are in the copy.*

ABRIDGED

SBC, AUGUSTA (1845)

SBC RESOLUTION, ATLANTA (1995)

SELECT PARTS OF THE HOLY BIBLE (LONDON, 1807)

MUSEUM OF THE BIBLE (2018–19)

NPR, DEC. 9, 2018

TKC: DOM

TKC: DOM

OPEN QUESTION

THE COPY AS DOCTRINE

FOR TKC

POSSIBLE The Book of Covenant is an abridgment on the 1807 model, the full canon on paper and a selection in practice. **OPEN QUESTION** Is it? Aurem's territory includes Georgia and South Carolina, where the Southern Baptist Convention was founded over slaveholding missionaries and apologized 150 years later (**DOM**).

WHAT THE BOOK OF COVENANT LEAVES OUT, IF IT DOES

WHO IN THE CAST OWNS A BOOK THEY SHOULDN'T, AND WHERE IT'S KEPT

The Black church

THE INVISIBLE INSTITUTION	Under slavery much Black Christian worship was what the sociologist E. Franklin Frazier called the "invisible institution," held in secret, often in woods and gullies known as hush harbors, beyond white supervision and the laws against Black gatherings. Albert Raboteau's *Slave Religion* (1978) is the standard history.
PHILADELPHIA	Richard Allen and other Black worshippers walked out of St. George's Methodist Church over segregated seating. Allen dated it to 1787, and some historians argue for 1792. He founded Mother Bethel in 1794, and in 1816 the African Methodist Episcopal Church became an independent denomination with Allen as its first bishop.
CHARLESTON	The African church that became Emanuel AME was burned by white authorities in 1822 after Denmark Vesey, one of its founders, was accused of planning a revolt. Its members worshiped in secret until 1865. On June 17, 2015, a white supremacist killed nine people at a Bible study in the same church.
WHAT GREW FROM IT	C. Eric Lincoln and Lawrence Mamiya describe seven historically Black denominations (1990). The spirituals, the exodus as the central story, the preaching tradition and the civil rights movement's base in churches, from the Southern Christian Leadership Conference in 1957 to King's last sermon, all come out of this history.

RABOTEAU, SLAVE RELIGION (1978)

FRAZIER, "INVISIBLE INSTITUTION"

MOTHER BETHEL (1794)

AME CHURCH (1816)

EMANUEL AME, CHARLESTON (1822, 2015)

LINCOLN & MAMIYA (1990)

SCLC (1957)

FOR TKC

INTERPRETATION Worship held out of sight of the authorities, in places the cameras don't reach. The Grace Bridge (**CR**) and the outer districts' kitchens (**DOM**) are the Empire's hush harbors. Douglass set "the slaveholding religion of this land" against "the Christianity of Christ," and Celeste's faith is on his side of that line. **POSSIBLE** Aurelia's outer districts remember the hush harbors, the burned church at Charleston and the walkout at St. George's, and the Temple teaches none of it.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

IS THERE A HUSH HARBOR IN SECTOR SEVEN? WHO LEADS IT, AND HAS EDEN BEEN?

Christian nationalism

CONTESTED, as a term and in its boundaries.

A DEFINITION	The sociologists Andrew Whitehead and Samuel Perry define it as "a cultural framework... that idealizes and advocates a fusion of Christianity with American civic life," and argue the "Christian" in it is more an identity than a faith.
A MEASUREMENT	A 2023 PRRI and Brookings survey built a scale from five statements about Christianity and American law and society. It classed about 10 percent of American adults as adherents and 19 percent as sympathizers, with 39 percent skeptics and 29 percent rejecters. Among white evangelical Protestants, 29 percent were adherents and 35 percent sympathizers.
THE OBJECTION	Critics, the political scientist Mark David Hall among them, argue the definitions are too broad and sweep in ordinary religious participation in politics.
THE EMBRACE	Some on the right have taken the term for themselves. Stephen Wolfe's *The Case for Christian Nationalism* (2022) argues for it openly.

WHITEHEAD & PERRY, TAKING AMERICA BACK FOR GOD (2020)

PRRI · BROOKINGS (FEB. 2023)

HALL, CHRISTIAN REFLECTIONS ON CHRISTIAN NATIONALISM

WOLFE, THE CASE FOR CHRISTIAN NATIONALISM (2022)

TKC: TL

FOR TKC

INTERPRETATION The Coalition, as the timeline describes it, megachurches, political action groups and militias running candidates at every level (TL), fits Whitehead and Perry's definition closely. It's a reading of your own invented history, and the real-world use of the term is CONTESTED.

WHO IN THE FOUNDING GENERATION READ WINTHROP, DOUGLASS AND RUSHDOONY, AND WHAT THEY TOOK FROM EACH

RUSHDOONY, INSTITUTES OF BIBLICAL LAW (1973)

BAHNSEN, THEONOMY (1977)

THEONOMY: A REFORMED CRITIQUE (1990)

DIAMOND, SPIRITUAL WARFARE (1989)

TAYLOR, THE VIOLENT TAKE IT BY FORCE (2024)

Reconstruction, dominion, seven mountains

CHRISTIAN RECONSTRUCTIONISM	R. J. Rushdoony founded the Chalcedon Foundation in 1965 and published *The Institutes of Biblical Law* in 1973, arguing that God's law in scripture, the Torah's case laws included, should be the standard for civil law. Greg Bahnsen's *Theonomy in Christian Ethics* (1977) gave the position its name, and Gary North extended it into economics. Its most distinctive claim is that the Mosaic civil penalties remain valid, and its writers listed the death penalty for offenses including adultery, homosexual acts, blasphemy and witchcraft. **CONTESTED** How consistently Rushdoony applied the penalties. Most evangelical and Reformed theologians rejected theonomy, and Westminster Seminary's faculty published a critique in 1990. Rushdoony's influence on Christian schooling and homeschooling was large and is acknowledged on both sides.
DOMINIONISM	CONTESTED, as a label. Sara Diamond described "dominion theology" in 1989, and Frederick Clarkson and others used "dominionism" for Christian Right groups that read Genesis 1.28 as a mandate for Christian control of public life. Critics call it a smear used too loosely.

Reconstruction, dominion, seven mountains, continued

RUSHDOONY, INSTITUTES OF BIBLICAL LAW (1973)

BAHNSEN, THEONOMY (1977)

THEONOMY: A REFORMED CRITIQUE (1990)

DIAMOND, SPIRITUAL WARFARE (1989)

TAYLOR, THE VIOLENT TAKE IT BY FORCE (2024)

THE SEVEN MOUNTAINS	The mandate holds that Christians are called to influence or lead seven spheres: family, religion, education, media, arts and entertainment, government and business. Proponents trace it to a 1975 meeting where Loren Cunningham and Bill Bright each received the same list, framed as evangelism. After Lance Wallnau heard it from Cunningham in 2000 and was mentored by C. Peter Wagner of the New Apostolic Reformation, it took a more political turn. Some trace it back to Abraham Kuyper's "sphere sovereignty." Matthew D. Taylor traces the movement's networks and their role on January 6, 2021, including the Appeal to Heaven flag.

FOR TKC

POSSIBLE Whoever named the Dominions held the dominionist reading of Genesis 1.28 and chose the word because of it. The Triune Rule puts three of the seven mountains, religion, government and media, into the constitution as the Temple, the Crown and the Broadcast (TL), and the founders may have thought of the Trials as taking the "family" mountain. The Covenant Court may cite theonomist arguments for Imperial penalties and quietly decline the parts of Mosaic law that would bind the Crown.

WHICH OF THE SEVEN MOUNTAINS THE EMPIRE THINKS IT HASN'T TAKEN YET

DANVERS STATEMENT (1987–88)

CBE, "MEN, WOMEN AND BIBLICAL EQUALITY" (1989)

TKC: CR · DOM

Headship, settled in 1987

DANVERS	The Council on Biblical Manhood and Womanhood drafted the complementarian Danvers Statement in Danvers, Massachusetts, in December 1987 and published it in final form in November 1988.
CHRISTIANS FOR BIBLICAL EQUALITY	Founded in 1987. It published its egalitarian statement, "Men, Women and Biblical Equality," in 1989, and it reached a wide audience in *Christianity Today* in 1990.

FOR TKC

The Temple's official theology of marriage (CR) is the Danvers position written into civil law and enforced at the counter. INFERENCE The egalitarian position has no legal standing in the Empire. OPEN QUESTION Do its arguments survive in Meridian's Reading Circles or in Heartland's theological inquiry (DOM)?

A TIMELINE, 1630 TO 2024

YEAR	EVENT
1630	Massachusetts Bay. "A city upon a hill."
1740	South Carolina bans teaching enslaved people to write
1787	The walkout at St. George's, Philadelphia
1807	The "Slave Bible," London
1816	The AME Church becomes independent
1822	Vesey. Emanuel burned. Furman's exposition.
1845	The Southern Baptist Convention, Augusta
1957	The Southern Christian Leadership Conference
1973	Rushdoony, *Institutes of Biblical Law*
1987	Danvers. Christians for Biblical Equality.
1995	The SBC apology, Atlanta
2015	Emanuel AME, Charleston
2021	January 6

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHERE MY TIMELINE STARTS TO DIVERGE, AND THE FIRST YEAR THAT ISN'T OURS

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

PART IX LOG

Working Questions

1 · WHICH OF THE FIVE BIBLICAL EMPIRES DOES CELESTE COMPARE THE COVENANT EMPIRE TO, AND WHICH ONE DOES THE TEMPLE?

2 · WHAT DID ATLANTA'S BLACK CHURCHES DO BETWEEN 2033 AND 2044, AND WHAT'S LEFT OF THEM IN AURELIA?

3 · DOES THE COVENANT COURT EVER CITE LEVITICUS 20 OR DEUTERONOMY 22 IN A SENTENCE? WRITE THE CASE.

4 · WHO CHOSE THE WORD "DOMINION," AND DID THEY READ GENESIS 1.28 THE WAY DOMINIONISTS DO?

5 · IF A CHARACTER FOUND A FULL, UNABRIDGED BIBLE IN 2104, WHAT WOULD SHE READ FIRST, AND WHAT WOULD HAPPEN TO HER FOR OWNING IT?

6 · WHAT WOULD A DOUGLASS OF THE EMPIRE WRITE IN HER APPENDIX?